Superintendent's Report

School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon
Regular Board Meeting of January 10, 2005
AGENDA

1. Announcements/Celebrations
2. Election of Board Leadership
3. Annenberg Report
4. Superintendent's Recommendation on Future of Blanchard Education Service Center
5. Enrollment: Decision-Making Framework
6. Student Representative's Report
7. First Reading of Policy: 8.30.010-P, District Funds for Purchase of Meals and Refreshments for Meetings
8. Opening Day of Legislature
9. Business Agenda
10. Other Business
11. Remaining Citizen Comment
12. Adjourn

INFORMAL MINUTES
Regular Board Meeting, January 10, 2005

The regular meeting of the Board of Directors came to order at 6:35 PM on the above date at the call of Co-Chair Julia Brim-Edwards in the Auditorium of the Blanchard Education Service Center, 501 North Dixon Street, Portland, Oregon.

There were present:

Board of Directors:
Julia Brim-Edwards, Co-Chair
Lolenzo Poe, Co-Chair
Derry A. Jackson, Sr.
Douglas Morgan -- *absent*
Bobbie Regan
Dilafruz Williams
David Wynde

Student Representative:
Suleima Cortez

Staff:
Vicki L. Phillips, Superintendent
Jollee Faber Patterson, General Counsel/Board Secretary
Julie Joel, Executive Assistant, Board of Education

1. ANNOUNCEMENTS/CELEBRATIONS

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards explained the agenda for the evening and announced that the January 24, 2005 School Board meeting will be held at Hosford Middle School. She thanked Principal Melissa Sandven and staff for hosting the Board that evening.

Aid to Tsunami Victims

Director Wynde discussed the devastating disaster that occurred over the Winter Break. He noted schools were individually raising money for relief efforts for victims of this disaster through a variety of fund-raising efforts. He stated there would be a concert at Grant High School provided by Grant alumni Tom Lauderdale of Pink Martini. Director Wynde thanked the students for the tremendous outpouring of efforts. Mercy Corps International and Northwest Medical Teams are both from the Portland area and are leaders in this international effort.

Celebrate! Portland Public Schools

Director Jackson noted the Board Book cover for the evening featured the flyer for the Celebrate! Portland Public Schools event to take place on Tuesday, January 18, from 5:30-8:30 PM at the Memorial Coliseum. He said this would be an opportunity for families and students to visit every school. There will also be performances by PPS students, and families will learn what to do for kindergarten enrollment and much more. Childcare and language translation services will be available, and there will also be free transportation from six area high schools.

Recognition of Margaret Kisser

Darin Matthews, Director of Procurement, announced that Margaret Kisser, PPS Procurement Specialist, was recently recognized as a "Partners in Public Procurement Purchasing Hero" by the Oregon Department of Administrative Services. Mr. Matthews said this is their highest award, and Ms. Kisser was the recipient because she secured donated and discounted school supplies for PPS children in need.

The Board Co-Chairs and Superintendent Phillips presented Ms. Kisser with the plaque from the Oregon Department of Administrative Services.

Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. Celebration

Ken Berry, former PPS administrator and currently the Executive Director of the event, discussed "Keep Alive the Dream" honoring the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., to be held at Jefferson High School on Monday, January 17, 2005 from noon to 7 PM.

Johnell Bell, former Student Representative to the School Board, has been assisting Mr. Berry in putting together the event. He stated it is a time for everyone in the community to come together to celebrate a great American who stood up for justice, education and civic action.

Mr. Berry noted some of the event sponsors as Portland Public Schools, Portland Association of Teachers, Safeco, Providence Health Center, Portland Community College, Enterprise Rent a Car, Portland General Electric and Killingsworth Little Chapel of the Chimes.

Co-Chair Poe thanked Mr. Berry and Mr. Bell for all their efforts toward this event.

Thanks to Former School Board Member Bill Scott's Family for Donation of Books

Ms. Scott shared comments with the Board regarding a donation to schools that was made on behalf of her father's, Bill Scott's, 60th birthday. Mr. Scott is a former PPS School Board member (1979-1987). She said Mr. Scott's family wanted to give back to the community and honor his birthday, and they gathered money and bought books for all 62 PPS elementary schools.

On behalf of the Board of Education, Director Williams thanked Ms. Scott and her family for their generosity.

Wild Oats Donation

Director Williams stated another community partner is supporting PPS students – Wild Oats Natural Marketplace. They made a generous donation of $3,462 to Portland Public Schools' Nutrition Services Department through their 5% Day program. She indicated that once a month Wild Oats donates 5% of a day's total revenue to a worthwhile cause in the community. The money donated to PPS was used to help pay for meals, specifically 1,730 lunches for students who came to school without lunch money during the first few weeks of school. Director Williams thanked Wild Oats for their generosity on behalf of our students.

2. **ELECTION OF BOARD LEADERSHIP**

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted the success of the co-chair model used by she and Co-Chair Poe.

Co-Chair Poe said he greatly appreciated the trust placed in him and Co-Chair Brim-Edwards to lead the Board during a critical time. He thanked his wife his fellow Board members for their support. He especially thanked Director Williams for opening up the idea of a co-chair model. Co-Chair Poe stated it had been a privilege to work with the staff and thanked Jollee Patterson, Julie Joel and Josie Hashemian for their support. He said appreciated the opportunity to work with Co-Chair Brim-Edwards and added he gained a life-long friend in her.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards thanked the Board and the community for their support of her and Co-Chair Poe. She said she was glad to have the opportunity to lead during a challenging time. She commented that having other Board members share leadership will ultimately strengthen the Board. Co-Chair Brim-Edwards reviewed where the Board was at the beginning of her and Co-Chair Poe's tenure as co-chairs and where they were collectively as a Board at this point in time. She thanked her husband, Randall Edwards, her three children, and her mother for their support. Co-Chair Brim-Edwards thanked her fellow Board members for their confidence in her and Co-Chair Poe and for their expertise and leadership on their collective agenda. She further acknowledged and thanked Director Jackson for coming up with the co-chair concept and presented him with a gift for helping to form a leadership team.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards thanked Paula McCullough, former principal of Ainsworth Elementary School, where her children attended school. She thanked all the principals for the profound impact they had on her leadership, especially thanking Rose Bond, Debra Bradway, and Vonnie Condon who served as PAPSA Presidents. She further thanked Ms. Condon for challenging the "new" Board in July of 2003 at the swearing-in ceremony. She went on to thank the central office staff for their expertise, creativity and flexibility. She thanked the many teachers and school staff for welcoming the Board into schools, and she thanked the PPS parents and the broader community.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted that the Portland Schools Foundation was a critical partner to PPS. She individually thanked Board staff for their efforts and had each come forward to receive a special gift: Jollee Patterson, General Counsel/Board Secretary; Josie Hashemian, Administrative Assistant to General Counsel; and Julie Joel, Executive Assistant to the Board. Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted that Co-Chair Poe

always advocated for children who needed a voice, and she enjoyed the co-chairship with him. She said she learned much from Co-Chair Poe. She presented him with a special gift. In closing, she said she had great hope and confidence in Superintendent Phillip's leadership to make a good district a great district.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards called for nominations for Board Chair.

Co-Chair Poe nominated Director Wynde.

There were no further nominations. Resolution 3187 was put to a roll call vote and passed unanimously 6-0 (Director Morgan absent; Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial).

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards called for nominations for Board Vice-Chair.

Director Williams nominated Director Regan.

There were no further nominations. Resolution 3188 was put to a voice vote and passed unanimously 6-0 (Director Morgan absent; Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial).

Director Wynde said Julia Brim-Edwards and Lolenzo Poe served as co-chairs for two years and did a marvelous job, and he added the people of Portland owed them a debt of gratitude for their leadership and service.

Director Wynde, Director Regan and Superintendent Phillips presented Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe with plaques and gavels in honor of their service as Co-Chairs of the Portland School Board.

Director Regan thanked the Board for their vote of confidence in her and she thanked Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe for their stable leadership, and said they were an effective and unified Board due to their efforts. Director Regan noted that Director Wynde will serve as the leadership point person for student achievement, including the achievement gap, progress for all students, achievement measurements, and academic accountability. He will also be the point person for finance, audit and operations including financial accountability, facilities, enrollment data review, budget and central office redesign. She also thanked her husband, Barry, and her two children for their support. Director Regan said she looked forward to working closely with Superintendent Phillips and staff to make Portland Public Schools a great school district.

Director Wynde clarified the role Director Regan would have as the new Board Co-Chair. He said Director Regan will serve as the leadership point

person on public policy issues, including the Board's legislative agenda, its broader public policy agenda, and building state and local alliances with other K-12 education interests. She will also be the leadership point person on communications and community relations, including communications strategy, developing a communications infrastructure and pro-active community engagement and outreach and the Board's response to community concerns. Director Wynde thanked his wife Sharon, and his two daughters for their support. He said he and Director Regan would continue with the co-chair model. In closing he offered a quote from Charles Dickens' Tale of Two Cities: "It was the best of times, it was the worst of times, it was the age of wisdom, it was the age of foolishness, it was the epoch of belief, it was the epoch of incredulity, it was the season of Light, it was the season of Darkness, it was the spring of hope, it was the winter of despair, we had everything before us, we had nothing before us, we were all going direct to Heaven, we were all going direct the other way – in short, the period was so far like the present period …"

3. **ANNENBERG REPORT**

Superintendent Phillips introduced Marla Ucelli and Greg Hodge from the Annenberg Institute and Cynthia Guyer from the Portland Schools Foundation. The presence in the audience of various members of the Foundation's Board of Directors was also noted.

Marla Ucelli referenced the "Findings and Recommendations from the Central Office Review for Results & Equity" (a copy of this report is attached to the minutes or may be obtained in the Board Support Office).

Greg Hodge said there was a need for the central office to support school reform so it would sustain. He said once choice is created in a public school system, it then must work and parents want to know that they can be a part of any process. He listed the five recommendations of the Central Office Review for Results and Equity (CORRE)report as: 1) Develop and communicate a central office service orientation; 2) Build (or re-build) centralized guidance and support for instruction; 3) Make collecting, organizing, analyzing, and acting on data on student achievement and staff and program efficacy a priority across the district; 4) Provide supports for schools and their students as determined by a deeper understanding of their needs and assets; and 5) Directly address unhealthy relationships and ineffective structures across central office and with schools.

Ms. Ucelli acknowledged the work of the lead liaison for Portland Public Schools, Dr. Patricia Pickles, Chief Academic Officer. She further acknowledged the work of Leslie Rennie-Hill, Portland Schools Foundation, Carolyn Leonard, PPS Compliance Officer, and Deborah Higa, Administrative Assistant to Dr. Pickles.

Cynthia Guyer, Director of the Portland Schools Foundation, thanked the Board for embracing the Annenberg findings and recommendations. She said it codified what many PPS parents and teachers have said and what the Foundation hears from business leaders and others. She said they need to be resolved to work together to meet the challenges. She thanked Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe who welcomed the process and were leaders in that process.

J.S. May, President of the Portland Schools Foundation Board, stated he was delighted to partner with PPS and Annenberg in this process. He said he wants to be a partner and to find the private resources to accomplish the recommendations of the report.

Superintendent Phillips said she was counting on courage and willingness to take PPS from words on paper to really deep action on all of the recommendations. She said to remember that it was about systemic issues, and there was no blame in terms of individuals. She said PPS failed to create certain conditions. She noted the pockets of excellence within PPS and said they needed to take those system-wide. Superintendent Phillips discussed some of the action steps that would be undertaken in the next few months. She indicated they would be redesigning Communications and Government Relations, Grants Management and rebuilding relationships and structures. Superintendent Phillips stated between now and June there would be a thorough and thoughtful realignment of central office functions and a change of how business is conducted in many areas. She said this will help the central office to more productively serve its schools. She said with the help of the Portland Schools Foundation in raising funds, they will bring in intensive technical assistance to do that work, and she added it would need to be done rapidly. Superintendent Phillips said in the next few months things would be intense.

Director Williams asked for elaboration on the diversity piece, specifically ELL (English Language Learners) and race relations.

Superintendent Phillips responded that piece would permeate every decision made and every program that is implemented. She said a number of things would be done in addition to ELL, and the District would

pursue an aggressive recruitment plan, and begin to help the staff and Board foster those difficult conversations.

Co-Chair Poe noted the difficult changes ahead and asked what the Board could do to support that work,

Ms. Ucelli responded it would begin with Board members continuing to ask the right questions. She said the second step was continuing to use the nucleus that was built with the convening of the CORRE team and continuing to use some group of that nature as a touchstone for progress. She also noted the importance of having external critical friends, such as Annenberg.

Mr. Hodge said it was important for leadership in the School District to model their own personal participation.

Director Wynde said as a Board, they need to have conversations about race and how it impacts their work, and he indicated the Board would get to that very soon as a way of modeling. He stated the importance of being clear up front what the matrix is for where the District is now, and a year from now what will PPS be doing differently and how will the Board know that things have changed.

Director Jackson said many children are struggling and suffering and the Board needs to be sure things get done. He said if there is a good idea in place, it is important to hear it and have the system absorb it and also collect the bright and wonderful ideas that come from people across the District.

Student Representative Cortez asked what was being done to communicate the information to students and parents.

Superintendent Phillips said they are beginning by making the findings public. She said the question now was how to take the information to the broader student community and the community in general. She said she would make sure there are a lot of student voices included in the action steps.

4. **SUPERINTENDENT'S RECOMMENDATION ON FUTURE OF BLANCHARD EDUCATION SERVICE DISTRICT**

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards said it was important to keep as much funding as possible focused on students. She thanked Pam Brown, Director of Facilities and Asset Management, for her work and noted per Board

Resolution 2558 (February 10, 2003), the School Board directed the Superintendent to provide a surplus property recommendation on the BESC by December 31, 2004.

Superintendent Phillips referenced her letter to Members of the School Board, dated December 22, 2004, Regarding "Recommendation on Blanchard Education Service Center (BESC) Disposition" (a copy of this document is attached to the minutes or may be obtained in the Board Support Office). She noted at the January 24, 2005 School Board meeting there would be a more in-depth report on the subject. She said the base of the recommendations is that PPS keep the BESC for another two to four years, and added it was not a good strategy at this time to sell the building and relocate staff. Superintendent Phillips noted that some development opportunities in the future would make the option of selling a more viable possibility. She said the District would make more effective and efficient use of the building in the meantime and work with the Real Estate Trust and begin to look at future development. Superintendent Phillips noted there were a number of recommendations around food services and other areas that they may need to take action on – even as early as this coming spring.

Director Wynde noted the process would be to make a presentation to the Finance, Audit and Operations Committee meeting prior to the next School Board meeting and report back to the full Board in more detail.

5. ENROLLMENT: DECISION-MAKING FRAMEWORK

Superintendent Phillips said review of enrollment data would lead to decision-making. She referenced the items in the Board Book pertaining to the enrollment discussion: She said trends in enrollment, building uses, educational programs and implications of any decisions such as boundary changes and school closures would be further explored. She said the end result would be a proposal for consideration by the Board and for community input and discussion. She said a decision by the Board would culminate at the late February meeting, but in the future the process would begin in October.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards said she been through a process in which there was analysis completed that was communicated to the school communities and individual schools regarding what the process would consist of so all could participate in that process. She emphasized that it was now jammed into three weeks of discussion in February.

Superintendent Phillips agreed that the timeframe this year would be somewhat tight. In future years, she said there would be ample time for input and comments from schools and the community. She stated whatever decisions are made, the implementation could be staggered in order to be reasonable. She said the goal was to have principals look at the proposal and give input to see if they believe it is a reasonable process. She said she was committed to a process that engaged schools early on, but she did not want to have people overly worried about something that might not be an eventuality. Superintendent Phillips said the next level of the process would involve recommendations to the Board that the schools and the community must consider.

Further Announcements

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards said there were several more announcements to make. She noted the Board Book for the evening was now available on the PPS website. She said getting to that point was a long-standing issue for her and Director Jackson. She specifically thanked Pam Jones, PPS Webteam, and Ryan McCarthy, Steve Anderson, and Richard Martin from Publication Technologies for making it happen.

Reminder – Public Comment on Three Board Policies: Co-Chair Brim-Edwards reminded all that the public comment period on three policies is due January 13th. 1) 5.60.010-P, Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment; 2) 1.40.080-P, Reimbursement of Expenses – Board of Directors; and 3) 4.10.051-P, Student Enrollment and Transfers. She noted the proposed policies could be reviewed at the PPS website (http://www.pps.k12.or.us/.docs/pg/6492.

Replays: Director Williams announced the replays of the January 10, 2005 meeting can be viewed on Channel 28 on:

Wednesday, Jan. 12, 2005	9:30 PM
Friday, Jan. 14, 2005	10:00 AM and 8:30 PM
Saturday, Jan. 15, 2005	7:30 PM
Sunday, Jan. 16, 2005	4:00 PM
Monday, Jan. 17, 2005	8:00 AM

6. STUDENT REPRESENTATIVE'S REPORT

Student Representative Suleima Cortez said SuperSAC had requested that Director Wynde address the group and discuss the budget, and he will be at their meeting this Thursday. Ms. Cortez said the student leadership retreat will be on Monday, January 31st, and she was working

with Jan Wierima, PPS Partnership Coordinator, to put the details of the retreat together. She noted that at the January 24, 2005 School Board meeting, the co-presidents from Madison High School would be addressing the Board and this would be the first in a series of reports from high school student body leadership.

7. FIRST READING OF POLICY

Director Regan, Chair of the Board's Community and Staff Relations Committee, and noted Policy 8.30.010-P, "District Funds for Purchase of Meals and Refreshments for Meetings" was a housekeeping item and she specifically thanked Heidi Franklin, Chief Financial Officer, for her work in putting the policy together.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards shared the First Reading information for the policy and noted the policy outlines guidelines for using District funds to provide meals and refreshments at meetings. She said the draft policy could be reviewed at the PPS website: http://www.pps.k12.or.us (click on the draft policy link). The policy contact is Heidi Franklin, P.O. Box 3107, Portland, OR 97208-3107. Her telephone number is 503-916-2000 and her email address is hfranklin@pps.k12.or.us. The last date for public comment is February 10, 2005.

8. OPENING DAY OF LEGISLATURE

Director Regan said she, along with Co-Chair Brim-Edwards, Director Wynde and Superintendent Phillips traveled to Salem for the opening of the 73rd session of the Oregon Legislature. She said that was the beginning of many, many trips they would take to Salem. Director Regan stated the vast majority of funding for public education comes from the state, and that had steadily decreased over the past year. She said PPS would have a strong presence in Salem this session to keep the issue of funding for schools a top priority. She encouraged parents and staff to visit or write their state legislators and encourage them to develop short- and long-term funding solutions.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards said there were many positive stories to share with legislators, including the work of Annenberg. She said the Board wants to be good stewards of funds and student achievement is a priority issue.

9. **BUSINESS AGENDA**

Ms. Joel noted a change to Resolution #3183 and read the change to the fourth "Whereas" into the record.

The Board unanimously approved the remaining items of the Business Agenda (vote: 6-0; Director Morgan absent; Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial).

10. **OTHER BUSINESS**

Director Wynde said the enrollment data review primarily focused on elementary schools, but the impact might be beyond the elementary level. He acknowledged the commentary in the newspaper recently with regard to Whitaker Middle School and its temporary location. He said pending a final decision regarding renewal of the capital bond, there needs to be serious thought given to what happens to that school site prior to the next school year. Director Wynde emphasized that the site on Columbia Boulevard was intended to be a temporary location, and it has been used far too long. He indicated he would like to see some alternatives for the location of that school.

Superintendent Phillips responded should would bring alternatives to the Board.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards said Whitaker Middle School was losing the capture rate, had shrinking enrollment and a majority of the problems was tied to the facility where the students are located and parents making decisions regarding what is best for their children. She suggested that perhaps the Finance, Audit and Operations Committee could work out a timeframe with staff from Facilities.

11. **REMAINING CITIZEN COMMENT**

John Grueschow – Mr. Grueschow, representing the War Resisters League, Portland Chapter, said colleges have first amendment rights to exclude military recruiters from their campus, and urged the Board to challenge the No Child Left Behind Act requirements that would withhold funds from school districts if military recruiters were barred from high school campuses.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards asked the Chairs of the Finance, Audit and Operations Committee and the Community and Staff Relations Committee to discuss at upcoming meetings.

12. **ADJOURN**

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted Finance, Audit and Operations Committee and the Community and Staff Relations Committee would have new chairs, as Directors Wynde and Regan, the new Board Co-Chairs, are currently the respective committee chairs. Co-Chair Brim-Edwards thanked the staff of Television Services for all they do for the Board.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards announced the next regular meeting of the Board of Education will be held at on Monday, January 24, 2005, at 6:30 PM in the Media Center at Hosford Middle School.

The regular meeting of the Board of Education for January 10, 2005 adjourned at 9:36 PM at the call of Co-Chair Julia Brim-Edwards.

Submitted by:

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Julie Joel, Executive Assistant
PPS Board of Education